

Graeme Blair

Current appointments

Associate Professor of Political Science, UCLA, 2022–

Past appointments

Co-Director of Training and Methods, Evidence in Governance and Politics, 2022–2024

Assistant Professor of Political Science, UCLA, 2016–2022

Pre/Post-Doctoral Fellow, Evidence in Governance and Politics & Earth Institute, Columbia University, 2014–16

Education

Ph.D., Politics, Princeton University, 2016

A.M., Politics, Princeton University, 2010

B.A., Political Science, Reed College, 2006

Coursework, University of KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa, 2004

Koobi Fora Field School, Kenya, 2001

Research

Books

2. Graeme Blair, Fotini Christia, and Jeremy M. Weinstein (eds.) with Eric Arias, Emile Badran, Robert A. Blair, Ellen Chapin, Ali Cheema, Ahsan Farooqui, Thiemo Fetzer, Guy Grossman, Dotan Haim, Zulfikar Hameed, Rebecca Hanson, Ali Hasanain, Ben Kachero, Dorothy Kronick, Andrew Miller, Benjamin Morse, Robert Muggah, Fatiq Nadeem, Matthew Nanes, Tara Slough, Nico Ravanilla, Jacob N. Shapiro, Barbara Silva, Pedro C. L. Souza, and Anna Wilke. *Crime, Insecurity, and Community Policing: Experiments on Building Trust*. 2024, Cambridge University Press (Studies in Comparative Politics series).
1. Graeme Blair, Alexander Coppock, and Macartan Humphreys. *Research Design in the Social Sciences: Declaration, Diagnosis, and Redesign*. 2023, Princeton University Press. Manuscript at book.declaredesign.org.
Reviews: *Nature* (“best science picks”)

Articles and chapters

20. Graeme Blair, Darin Christensen, and Michael Gibilisco. “The point of attack: Where and why does oil cause armed conflict?” Accepted, *Journal of Politics*.
19. Rebecca Littman*, Rebecca Wolfe*, Graeme Blair*, and Sarah Ryan. 2023. “Evidence required for ethical social science.” *Science* 379(6629):247. * Equal authors.
18. Biz Herman  Amma Panin  Elizabeth Iams Wellman  Graeme Blair  Lindsey D. Pruett  Ken Ochieng’ Opalo  Hannah M. Alarian  Allison N. Grossman  Yvonne Tan  Alex P. Dyzenhaus  and Nicholas Owsley. 2022. “Field Experiments in the Global South: Assessing Risks, Localizing Benefits, and Addressing Positionality.” *PS: Political Science & Politics* 55(4): 769–772. *Author order randomized.
17. Graeme Blair and Nirvikar Jassal. 2022. “Improving Access to Justice for Survivors of Violence Against Women.” *Science* 377(6602): 150–151.

16. Graeme Blair, Jeremy M. Weinstein, Fotini Christia, Eric Arias, Emile Badran, Robert A. Blair, Ali Cheema, Ahsan Farooqui, Thiemo Fetzner, Guy Grossman, Dotan Haim, Zulfiqar Hameed, Rebecca Hanson, Ali Hasanain, Dorothy Kronick, Benjamin Morse, Robert Muggah, Fatiq Nadeem, Matthew Nanes, Tara Slough, Nico Ravanilla, Jacob N. Shapiro, Barbara Silva, Pedro C. L. Souza, and Anna Wilke. 2021. "Does Community Policing Build Trust in Police and Reduce Crime? Evidence from Six Coordinated Field Experiments in the Global South." *Science* 374(6571).
Invited perspective by Santiago Tobón, "Community policing in the developing world." *Science*.
15. Graeme Blair, Rebecca Littman, Elizabeth R. Nugent, Rebecca Wolfe, Mohammed Bukar, Benjamin Crisman, Anthony Etim, Chad Hazlett, and Jiyoung Kim. 2021. "Trusted Authorities Can Change Minds and Shift Norms during Conflict." *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* 118 (42).
14. Graeme Blair, Darin Christensen, and Valerie Wirtschafter. 2020. "How does armed conflict shape investment? Evidence from the mining sector." *Journal of Politics* 84(1): 116-133.
13. Graeme Blair, Darin Christensen, and Aaron Rudkin. 2021. "Do Commodity Price Shocks Cause Armed Conflict? Evidence from a Meta-Analysis." *American Political Science Review* 115(2): 709-716.
12. Graeme Blair and Gwyneth McClendon. "Experiments in Multiple Contexts." Chapter in *Advances in Experimental Political Science*, James N. Druckman and Donald P. Green eds., 2021. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
11. Graeme Blair, Alexander Coppock, and Margaret Moor. 2020. "When to Worry about Sensitivity Bias: A Social Reference Theory and Evidence from 30 Years of List Experiments." *American Political Science Review* 114(4): 1297-1315.
10. Graeme Blair, Winston Chou, and Kosuke Imai. 2019. "List Experiments with Measurement Error." *Political Analysis* 27(4): 455-480.
9. Graeme Blair, Jasper Cooper, Alexander Coppock, and Macartan Humphreys. 2019. "Declaring and Diagnosing Research Designs." *American Political Science Review* 113(3): 838-859.
8. Graeme Blair, Rebecca Littman, and Elizabeth Levy Paluck. 2019. "Motivating the Adoption of New Community-Minded Behaviors: An Empirical Test in Nigeria." *Science Advances* 5(3):1-8.
7. Robin Gomila, Rebecca Littman, Graeme Blair, and Elizabeth Levy Paluck. 2017. "The Audio Check: A Method for Improving Data Quality and Detecting Data Fabrication." *Social Psychological and Personality Science*. 8(4): 424-433.
6. Graeme Blair, Kosuke Imai, and Yang-Yang Zhou. 2015. "Statistical Analysis of the Randomized Response Technique." *Journal of the American Statistical Association* 110(511): 1304-1319.
5. Graeme Blair. 2015. "Survey Methods for Sensitive Topics." *APSA Comparative Politics Newsletter* 24(1): 12-16.
4. Graeme Blair, Kosuke Imai, and Jason Lyall. 2014. "Comparing and Combining List and Endorsement Experiments: Evidence from Afghanistan." *American Journal of Political Science* 58(4): 1043-1063.
3. Jason Lyall, Graeme Blair, and Kosuke Imai. 2013. "Explaining Support for Combatants during Wartime: A Survey Experiment in Afghanistan." *American Political Science Review* 107(4): 679-705.
2. Graeme Blair, C. Christine Fair, Neil Malhotra, and Jacob N. Shapiro. 2013. "Poverty and Support for Militant Politics: Survey Evidence from Pakistan." *American Journal of Political Science* 57(1): 30-48.
1. Graeme Blair and Kosuke Imai. 2012. "Statistical Analysis of List Experiments." *Political Analysis* 20: 47-77.

Awards & fellowships

Best book (for *Research Design in the Social Sciences*), American Political Science Association Experiments Section, 2024

Honorable mention for best article award (for *Does Community Policing Build Trust in Police and Reduce Crime?*), American Political Science Association Comparative Politics Section, 2023

Best book (for *Advances in Experimental Political Science*), American Political Science Association Experiments Section, 2022

“Featured evaluation from across government departments to demonstrate best practices for public policy evaluation,” U.K. Cabinet Office Evaluation Task Force, 2022

Commendation (for DeclareDesign), Society for the the Improvement of Psychological Science, 2020

Statistical Software Award for “developing statistical software that makes a significant research contribution,” Society for Political Methodology, 2019

Leamer-Rosenthal Prize for Open Social Science, Berkeley Initiative for Transparency in the Social Sciences, \$10,000, 2016

Post-Doctoral Fellowship, Watson Institute for International Studies, Brown (declined), 2014

Pi Sigma Alpha Award for best paper, Midwest Political Science Association, \$250, 2013, with Kosuke Imai and Jason Lyall

Graduate Fellow, Institute for International and Regional Studies, Princeton, 2013

Graduate Fellow, Program on Quantitative and Analytical Political Science, Princeton, 2012 – 2013

Prize Fellow (university-wide), Woodrow Wilson Scholars, Princeton, 2011

Software

DeclareDesign, R statistical package for diagnosing and improving research designs, with Jasper Cooper, Alexander Coppock, Macartan Humphreys, and Neal Fultz

fabricatr, R statistical package for simulating social science data before it is collected, with Jasper Cooper, Alexander Coppock, Macartan Humphreys, and Aaron Rudkin

estimatr, R statistical package for fast estimators for social scientists, with Jasper Cooper, Alexander Coppock, Macartan Humphreys, and Luke Sonnet

rr, R statistical package for analysis of randomized response technique survey items designed to elicit truthful answers to sensitive questions, with Yang-Yang Zhou and Kosuke Imai

list, R statistical package for analysis of survey “list experiments” designed to elicit truthful answers to sensitive questions, with Kosuke Imai

Extramural grants

Innovations for Poverty Action, \$149,259, 2024–2026. For Asking About Violence, co-PI with Hannah Baron, Abdulrasheed Isah, Sandra Ley, Rebecca Littman, Andrés Moya, Alejandra Rios, Elayne Stecher, Lauren Young

Arnold Ventures, \$25,000, 2023–2024. For review of policing randomized trials, co-PI with Robert A. Blair, Santiago Tobón, and Anna Wilke

National Science Foundation, \$400,000, 2022–2025. For Asking About Violence, co-PI with Rebecca Littman and Lauren Young

Innovations for Poverty Action, \$129,955, 2022–2024. For Asking About Violence, co-PI with Hannah Baron, Rebecca Littman, Elayne Stecher, Lauren Young, Sandra Ley, Mohammed Bukar, Andr es Moya, and Vivian Khedari DePierro

Hewlett Foundation, \$800,000, 2021–2024. For Project on Resources and Governance, co-PI with Darin Christensen.

International Growth Centre, \$25,700, 2020, co-PI with Darin Christensen

International Growth Centre, \$25,800, 2019, co-PI with Darin Christensen and Michael Ross

Hewlett Foundation, \$1,400,000, 2018–2020. For Project on Resources, Governance, and Development, co-PI with Darin Christensen and Michael Ross

Peace and Recovery Fund, Innovations for Poverty Action, \$40,000, 2018, co-PI with Rebecca Littman and Rebecca Wolfe

Economic Development and Institutions Program (U.K. Department for International Development), \$30,000, 2018. For “Engaging Citizens to Address Company-Community Conflicts at South African Mines,” with Darin Christensen and Renard Sexton

Hewlett Foundation, \$600,000, 2017–2018. For Project on Resources, Governance, and Development, co-PI with Darin Christensen, Laura Paler, and Michael Ross

Laura and John Arnold Foundation, \$491,000, 2016–2018. Lead PI (\$322,839 award to UCLA). For “Declaring and Diagnosing Research Designs,” with Jasper Cooper, Alexander Coppock, and Macartan Humphreys

Evidence in Governance and Politics and U.K. Department for International Development, \$1,300,000 (\$109,978 award to UCLA), 2016–2020. For “*Metaketa* Initiative on Community Policing,” chair and lead author

Development Innovation Lab/USAID grant, \$5,000, 2017, with Darin Christensen and Renard Sexton

Amazon AWS Research Grant, \$3,000, 2014, with Kosuke Imai and Carlos Velasco

CAF-America Latina Crime and Policy Network Citizen Security in Latin America Grant, \$15,000, 2013, with Kosuke Imai, Fabiana Machado, Carlos Velasco

National Science Foundation Dissertation Improvement Grant (SES-1226228), \$17,640, 2012

International Growth Centre, LSE, \$116,000, 2010, with Kosuke Imai

Internal grants

California Center for Population Research Seed Grant, UCLA, \$18,000, 2025

Center for the Advancement of Teaching (for PS 50), UCLA, \$5,000, 2021

Center for Social Statistics, UCLA, \$20,000, 2017, with Chad Hazlett

Dean’s Faculty Opportunity Fund (for IDSS graduate workshop), UCLA, \$1,500, 2017, with Darin Christensen and Chad Hazlett

California Center for Population Research Seed Grant, UCLA, \$17,200, 2016, with Chad Hazlett

Institute for International and Regional Studies, Princeton, 2010; 2012

Bobst Center for Peace and Justice, Princeton, 2010; 2011; 2011, with Kosuke Imai; 2011, with Carlos Velasco

Field research

Nigeria: January, March 2020 (North East); March-April 2018 (North East); July 2017 (North East); March, September 2016 (North East); February, July 2015 (North East); November 2012 – February 2013 (Niger Delta); January, May, July 2012 (Niger Delta); July – August 2011 (North East, Niger Delta); July – August 2010 (Abuja); August 2009 (Lagos)

South Africa: September 2019; December 2018; August 2017; January 2006

Mexico: March, April 2012

Equatorial Guinea: January 2012

Ghana: June 2010; June 2009

Liberia: July 2009

Teaching

PS 50. Comparative politics (undergraduate), UCLA

PS 150. Political violence (undergraduate), UCLA

PS 179. Randomized trials for social change (undergraduate), UCLA

PS 200E. Experimental design for social science (graduate), UCLA

PS 292B. Research design for social science (graduate), UCLA

PS 240A-B. Comparative politics field seminar (graduate), UCLA

Research design short courses: Nigeria Ministry of Agriculture, 2015; EITM Europe, 2019; EGAP Learning Days, Abidjan, 2022, 2023

Advisees and placement

Ph.D. students

Elayne Stecher (dissertation co-chair, ongoing)

Rachel Berwald (dissertation co-chair, ongoing)

Brigid Morris (dissertation chair, ongoing)

Carolyn Steinle (dissertation co-chair, ongoing)

Alfredo Trejo III (dissertation committee, ongoing)

Jiyoung Kim (dissertation committee)

Ryan Baxter-King (dissertation committee): Assistant professor, University of Nevada, Reno

Cesar Martinez Alvarez (dissertation committee): Assistant professor, UCSB; Postdoc, Yale

Valerie Wirtschafter (dissertation committee): Data analyst, Brookings Institution

Staff researchers

Sofía Granados: Ph.D. student, UCLA

Fatiq Nadeem: Ph.D. student, Bren School of the Environment, UCSB

J. Sebastián Leiva: M.P.P. student, Princeton

Jasmine Miller: Research manager, Give Directly

Undergraduate researchers

Safa Saleem

Omar Elamri

Belle Ho

Jason Leland

Jarod Ngo

Ophelia Sin

Ragini Srinivasan: Ph.D. student in economics, MIT

Guanzhang Zhao: Ph.D. student in economics, Yale

Saloni Majmudar: Associate consultant, Bain & Company

Jacquelyn Nguyen: medical school

Emily Allendorf: Research assistant, RAND Corporation

Min Woo Sun: Ph.D. student in biomedical informatics, Stanford

Professional service

Ad-hoc committee on research ethics, Empirical Studies of Conflict, 2023–

Advisory board member, Conflict Research Network West Africa, 2022–

Selection committee, CEGA Non-Resident Fellowship Pilot Research Grant, 2023

Selection committee, Empirical Studies of Conflict Annual Meeting, 2022

Co-organizer, Alternative academic career talk series, California Workshop in Empirical Political Science, 2022

Chair, Best dissertation award committee, APSA Experiments Section, 2022

Steering committee, Urban violence and policing research cluster, Evidence in Governance and Politics, 2021–

Organizer, Southern California Workshop in Empirical Political Science conference, 2020

Nominating committee co-chair, African Politics Conference Group, 2019–20

Selection committee, Statistical Software Award, Society for Political Methodology, 2019–21

Section co-chair, African Politics Conference Group, American Political Science Association meetings, 2019

Selection committee, California Workshop in Empirical Political Science conference, 2019

Selection committee, post-doctoral fellow, Evidence in Governance and Politics, 2016

Guest editor, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*

Referee, *American Journal of Political Science*, *American Political Science Review*, *British Journal of Political Science*, Cambridge University Press, *Comparative Political Studies*, *Conflict Management and Peace Science*, *International Studies Quarterly*, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, *Journal of Politics*, *Journal of the Royal Statistical Society (Series A)*, *Journal of Peace Research*, National Science Foundation, *Nature Communications*, *Nature Human Behaviour*, *Political Analysis*, *Political Behavior*, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *Public Opinion Quarterly*, *Research and Politics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Science*, *Science Advances*, *Terrorism and Political Violence*, University of California Press, and *World Politics*

University and department service

Panel member, Student Conduct Committee, UCLA, 2024–2027
Secretary and member of the executive committee, UCLA Faculty Association, 2024–
Advisory committee member, Center for the Study of Women, UCLA, 2024–
Retreat committee, California Center for Population Research, UCLA, 2023
Faculty recruitment committee, Department of Political Science, UCLA, 2022–23
Methods field chair, Department of Political Science, UCLA, 2019–20, 2020–21, 2021–22, 2022–23
Executive committee member, Department of Political Science, UCLA, 2019–20, 2020–21
Comparative politics field chair, Department of Political Science, UCLA, 2017–18
Faculty leader, Improving Designs in the Social Sciences (weekly graduate workshop), UCLA, 2016–17, 2017–18, with Darin Christensen, Erin Hartman, and Chad Hazlett
Co-organizer, Comparative Politics Workshop, Department of Political Science, UCLA, 2016–17, 2017–18
Deputy director of graduate placement, Department of Political Science, UCLA, 2016–17

Conferences and invited talks

2025: LSE, MIT
2023: Yale, Institute For Advanced Study in Toulouse, Paris Dauphine University, Syracuse
2022: Committee on Law and Justice, The National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine; UC Berkeley Center for African Studies; UNU World Institute for Development Economics Research (WIDER); DCAF Geneva Centre for Security Sector Reform; APSA; USC; Northwestern Global Poverty Action Lab; CEGA Evidence to Action meeting; ESOC; ITAM; EGAP; Australian Society for Quantitative Political Science (Keynote address)
2021: Montréal Methods Workshop; EGAP Methods Workshop; United States Institute of Peace
2020: Berkeley Africa Colloquium; NYU CESS; EGAP*; OECD Responsible Mining meeting*; Stanford Comparative Politics Workshop*; Innovations for Poverty Action Measurement meeting*; ESOC; Berkeley Center for Effective Global Action; APSA; BITSS RT-2 Workshop; U.K. Dept. for International Development; Stanford Political Science Workshop; Evidence in Governance and Politics; FHI 360; Innovations for Poverty Action; USAID Development Innovations Venture. * cancelled due to COVID-19
2019: Strategy and the Business Environment Conference; Empirical Studies of Conflict Conference (ESOC); Northwestern Experiments Conference; APSA; BITSS RT-2 Workshop, World Bank; Workshop in Experimental Social Sciences, Florence; EGAP; UBC Vancouver School of Economics
2018: Northwestern University, Q-Center; APSA; Facebook; PRG, Washington; PRG, Accra, Ghana; BITSS RT-2 Workshop
2017: U.K. Dept. for International Development; BITSS Annual Meeting; Project on Resources and Governance Conference, UCLA
2016: U.S. Dept. of State; Southern California Methods Workshop, UCSD; APSA, EGAP
2015: APSA
2014: Polmeth; APSA
2013: MPSA; Polmeth; APSA
2012: International Studies Association; Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA); Contemporary African Political Economy Research Seminar; Polmeth; APSA; Harvard-MIT-Yale Civil Conflict and Political Violence Conference

2011: NYU Center for Experimental Social Science conference (CESS); Princeton Conference on New Methods and Applications in Comparative and IR; Society for Political Methodology (Polmeth); American Political Science Association (APSA)

Expert work

Statistical consultant, University of California Sentencing Project, 2025–

Expert declarations (for motion to certify class and reply in support of motion to certify class), *Vasquez Perdomo v. Noem*, August 2025, U.S. District Court for the Central District of California

Brief of amicus curiae, *Calderon v. Bondi*, July 2025, U.S. Court of Appeals for the Ninth Circuit

Expert declaration, *Chung v. Trump*, March 2025, U.S. District Court for the Southern District of New York (with David Hausman)

Expert declaration, *Khalil v. Joyce et al.*, March 2025, U.S. District Court for the District of New Jersey (with David Hausman)

Policy advisory

Steering committee, Impact Data and Evidence Aggregation Library (IDEAL), World Bank, 2023–2024

Managing Exits from Conflict Nigeria (UNICEF, UNDP, IOM, UN University), 2019–2022

Mercy Corps Nigeria (unpaid), 2018–20

UNICEF Nigeria and UN University (unpaid), 2016–17

Office of the Special Adviser to the President on Petroleum Matters (unpaid), Nigeria, 2010–11

Affiliations

Faculty Affiliate, Department of Statistics, UCLA, 2022–

Faculty Affiliate, Center for Social Statistics, UCLA, 2018–

Co-executive director, Project on Resources and Governance, 2017–

Faculty Affiliate, Center for Effective Global Action, 2017–

Member, Evidence in Governance and Politics, 2016–

Faculty Affiliate, African Studies Program, UCLA, 2016–

Faculty Affiliate, California Center for Population Research, UCLA, 2016–

Researcher, International Growth Centre, 2012–

Professional memberships

African Politics Conference Group, American Political Science Association, Society for Political Methodology

Non-academic employment

Econsult Corporation, Philadelphia (urban economics statistical analyst), 2007–2008.

Grove Insight, Portland, Oregon (political survey research analyst), 2006.

References available upon request.

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